

IN PROFILE

The New York Philharmonic

Founded in 1842, the New York Philharmonic is the oldest of the “Big Five” US orchestras (New York Philharmonic, Boston Symphony Orchestra, Chicago Symphony Orchestra, Philadelphia Orchestra, and Cleveland Orchestra). Bernstein’s connection with the orchestra began in 1943, when he took up the post of assistant conductor. In 1957, he was appointed musical director jointly with Dimitri Mitropoulos, and a year later was made sole musical director. He was the first US-born conductor to occupy the post, which he held until 1969. He was then dubbed the orchestra’s “laureate conductor,” and continued working with it until his death.



BERNSTEIN REHEARSES WITH THE NEW YORK PHILHARMONIC,
CARNEGIE HALL

Born in 1918 into a family of Ukrainian Jewish immigrants in Lawrence, Massachusetts, Leonard Bernstein showed a gift for